



Topping the charts: Left-arm pacer Arshdeep Singh was India's top wicket-taker in the recent T20 World Cup, taking 17 wickets in eight matches with an economy under eight, helping Rohit Sharma's team to victory.

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current group of Indian pacers? How competitive is it with players like Jasprit Bumrah, Mohammed Siraj, and Hardik Pandya?

Healthy competition within the team is great. As individuals, we always strive to improve and compete with our teammates, which brings out the best in everyone and benefits the team. With Jassi (Bumrah) bhai, Siraj bhai, or Shami bhai around, we aim to match their skills and contributions. This drives us to work hard and perform at our best. During training, our target sessions are competitive, and bowling well to our legendary batters boosts our

morale.

Playing with Jassi bhai is challenging because his skills are exceptional. We try to get as close to his level as possible to improve our game and help the team. I'm focused on learning about body management, skill enhancement, and discipline.

What was going through your mind when you were given the 19th over in the final? How did you stay calm?

Since joining the Indian team in 2022, I've focused on bowling in the death overs and have become accustomed to it. By the 19th over, Jassi bhai and Hardik bhai had already set us up well by taking two key wickets and increasing the required run rate.

My job was to keep the runs down and give Hardik bhai a cushion for the final over. I used my variations against the new batter,

and it worked, leaving us with enough runs to defend in the last over.

Not long ago, you would bowl too many variations, getting hit in a few crunch situations. But over the last year, that seems to have changed. How much did the county stint with Kent help you on that front?

Before my time at Kent, I was mainly focused on playing T20 cricket. When you play T20s, you tend to rely on a lot of variations. However, while at Kent, I got the opportunity to bowl long spells and learned how effective length balls can be. This experience helped me a lot. Previously, when a batter attacked me, I would mainly use yorkers or a slow ball. My time at Kent taught me that bowling at a good length can make it difficult for a batter to score easy runs. After my stint there, I played ODIs in South Africa and